

# DINGYI (PENNY) PAN

(650)-788-9757 ◊ dipan@ucsd.edu

<https://pennydy.github.io/>

## EDUCATION

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**UC San Diego**, La Jolla, CA

*September 2023 - Present*

Ph.D. Student in Linguistics

Advisor: Andrew Kehler

**Stanford University**, Stanford, CA

*September 2021 - June 2023*

M.S. in Symbolic Systems

Thesis: “*Projection inferences with clause-embedding predicates in RSA models*”

Advisor: Judith Degen

**Vassar College**, Poughkeepsie, NY

*August 2017 - May 2020*

B.A. in Cognitive Science, Correlate in Computer Science, *Cum Laude*

Thesis: “*Are there roses in the maze?: Auditory word recognition in Mandarin-English bilinguals*”

Advisor: Janet Andrews

**LSA Summer Institute**, Amherst, MA

*2023*

**University of Washington**, Seattle, WA

*September 2016 - June 2017, Summer 2018*

Department of Linguistics

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Psycholinguistics, Pragmatics, Cognitive Science

## MANUSCRIPTS AND PEER-REVIEWED PAPERS

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\*: Equal contribution

Lu, J.\*, **Pan, D.\***, & Degen, J. (to appear). Discourse Effects on the Manner-of-Speaking Island. *Language*.

**Pan, D.**, & Kehler, A. (to appear). Do Large Language Models Recognize and Utilize Non-Mandated Pragmatic Enrichments? In *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.

**Pan, D.** & Kehler, A. (2025). Pragmatic Competence in LLMs: The Case of Eliciture. *Society for Computation in Linguistics*. 8(1): 43.

**Pan, D.**, & Bergen, B. (2025). Are explicit belief representations necessary? A comparison between Large Language Models and Bayesian probabilistic models. In *Proceedings of the 2025 Annual Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the ACL*.

**Pan, D.**, & Degen, J. (2023). Towards a computational account of projection inferences in clause-embedding predicates. In *Proceedings of the 45th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society*.

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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**Pan, D.** & Kehler, A. (2025). Do Large Language Models Recognize and Utilize Non-Mandated Pragmatic Enrichments? Poster to be presented at the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society. San Francisco, CA.

**Pan, D.** & Kehler, A. (2025). Pragmatic Competence in LLMs: The Case of Eliciture. Poster to be presented at the 8th Meeting of the Society for Computation in Linguistics (SCiL). Eugene, OR.

**Pan, D.** & Kehler, A. (2024). Can LLMs draw conversational elicitures and put them to use? Talk

presented at the 7th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 7). La Jolla, CA.

**Pan, D.** & Degen, J. (2024). A computational model for projection inferences in clause-embedding predicates. Poster presented at the 6th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 6). Stanford, CA.

Lu, J., **Pan, D.**, and Degen J. (2024). Evidence for a discourse account of Manner-of-Speaking islands. Talk presented at LSA. New York, NY.

**Pan, D.**, & Degen, J. (2023). Towards a computational account of projection inferences in clause-embedding predicates. Talk presented at the 45th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society. Sydney, Australia.

**Pan, D.**, Lu, J., & Degen, J. (2023). Discourse Foregrounding Ameliorates Manner-of-Speaking Islands. Poster presented at HSP 2023. Pittsburgh, PA.

**Pan, D.**, Lu, J., & Degen, J. (2023). Can Manner-of-Speaking Islands be Rescued Through Discourse Foregrounding? Short talk presented at the 5th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 5). Los Angeles, CA.

**OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE**

|                                                                           |                    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>interActive Language Processing Lab (ALPS)</b> , Stanford University   | <i>2022 - 2023</i> |
| Member, PI: Judith Degen (Linguistics)                                    |                    |
| <b>Cognitive Science Department</b> , Vassar College                      | <i>2019 - 2020</i> |
| Project member, Faculty mentor: Josh de Leeuw (Cognitive Science)         |                    |
| <b>Undergraduate Research Summer Institute (URSI)</b> , Vassar College    | <i>Summer 2019</i> |
| Member, Faculty mentor: Jonathon Gordon (Computer Science)                |                    |
| <b>Language Development and Processing Lab</b> , University of Washington | <i>Summer 2018</i> |
| Summer Volunteer, PI: Akira Omaki (Linguistics)                           |                    |
| <b>IMB Undergraduate Summer Workshop</b> , University of Pennsylvania     | <i>Summer 2018</i> |
| Attendee                                                                  |                    |
| <b>German Department</b> , Vassar College                                 | <i>2017 - 2018</i> |
| Research Assistant, Advisor: Lioba A. Gerhardi (German)                   |                    |

**AWARDS AND HONORS**

|                                                          |             |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| SCiL 2025 Travel Award (\$500)                           | <i>2025</i> |
| HSP 2023 Travel Award (\$400), University of Pittsburg   | <i>2023</i> |
| Eloise Ellery Fellowship (\$3000), Vassar College        | <i>2020</i> |
| <i>Phi Beta Kappa</i> , <i>Sigma Xi</i> , Vassar College | <i>2020</i> |
| <i>Psi Chi</i> , Vassar College                          | <i>2019</i> |

**TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

|                                                                       |                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>UC San Diego</b>                                                   |                                 |
| LIGN 117: The Language Code                                           | <i>Spring 2025</i>              |
| Instructor: Andrew Kehler                                             |                                 |
| LIGN 17: Making and Breaking Codes                                    | <i>Winter-Fall 2024</i>         |
| Instructor: Andrew Kehler                                             |                                 |
| LIGN 170: Psycholinguistics                                           | <i>Summer 2024</i>              |
| Instructor: Ebru Evcen                                                |                                 |
| <b>Stanford University</b>                                            |                                 |
| SYMSYS 1: Minds and Machines                                          | <i>Summer 2022, Winter 2023</i> |
| Instructors: David Gottlieb (Summer 2022), Noah Goodman (Winter 2023) |                                 |
| <b>Vassar College</b>                                                 |                                 |
| CMPU 101: Computer Science I: Problem-Solving and Abstraction         | <i>Winter 2019</i>              |
| Instructor: Luke Hunsberger                                           |                                 |

CHIN 305/306: Advance Chinese Chinese (as drill instructor)  
Instructor: Linfeng Li

2017 - 2018

## WORK EXPERIENCE

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**Cognitive Computing Lab**, Baidu Research, Beijing  
Linguistics Specialist Intern

January - July 2021

**Speech and Audio Team**, ByteDance AI Lab, Beijing  
Linguistics Specialist Intern

May - December 2020

## SERVICE

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### Journal Reviewer

First Language

2025

### Conference Reviewer

Cogsci

2025

California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP)

2022 - 2023

### Conference and Event Organizing Committees

Emerging Scholar Event, Center for Research in Language (CRL), UCSD

2025

The 7th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP 7), UCSD

2024

### Departmental Service

Colloquium Committee, Department of Linguistics, UCSD

2023 - Present

Admission Committee, Symbolic System Program, Stanford University

2023

## SKILLS

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### Languages

Mandarin Chinese (native), English (fluent),  
German (intermediate), Tigre (research knowledge)

### Programming Languages

Python, R, Java, Scheme, Racket, Linux, C++, Javascript, HTML,  
CSS, WebPPL